

How to Capture Streaming Audio on Windows 11

A Personal Use Tip for Home and Pro Users

Streaming services like Xfinity Stream play audio directly through your browser in real time. Nothing is saved to your computer automatically. However, Windows 11 includes a free built-in tool that lets you record what is playing on your screen — including the audio — for personal use.

OPTION 1 — Xbox Game Bar (Built Into Windows 11)

This is the recommended method. It requires no downloads, works on both Windows 11 Home and Pro, and uses your computer's graphics chip to record — so it has minimal impact on performance.

How to Use It:

1. Start your stream in Google Chrome and let it play.
2. Click on the Chrome window to make sure it is the active window.
3. Press **Win + G** on your keyboard to open the Game Bar overlay.
4. In the Capture widget, click the **Record button** (circle icon) — or press **Win + Alt + R**.
5. A small timer appears in the corner. Your audio and video are now recording.
6. When finished, press **Win + Alt + R** again to stop.
7. A notification will appear: *Game clip recorded*. Your file is saved.

Where Your File Is Saved:

Files are saved automatically to:

C:\Users\[your username]\Videos\Captures

Files are named automatically by app and date/time, for example:

Chrome_2026-06-29_14-35-22.mp4

Heads Up: Video files can be large. A 30-minute recording may use 1 to 4 GB of disk space. Move or delete files when you are done with them.

OPTION 2 — Audacity (Audio Only, Free Download)

If you only want the audio track and not the video, Audacity is an excellent free option. It records audio only, so files are much smaller — a 30-minute MP3 is roughly 28 MB.

One-Time Setup:

1. Download Audacity free from **audacityteam.org**
2. Open Audacity.
3. Set the Audio Host dropdown to **Windows WASAPI**.
4. Set the Input Device to your **speakers or headphones (loopback)**.

To Record:

1. Start your stream in Chrome.
2. Click the red **Record button** in Audacity.
3. When finished, click the **Stop button** (square icon).
4. Go to **File** → **Export** and save as MP3, WAV, or FLAC.

Where Your File Is Saved:

You choose the save location at export time. The default is:

C:\Users\[your username]\Documents

QUICK COMPARISON

Feature	Xbox Game Bar	Audacity
Install required?	No — built into Windows 11	Yes — free download
Records video?	Yes (MP4)	No — audio only
Records audio?	Yes	Yes
File size (30 min)	1 to 4 GB	~28 MB (MP3)
PC performance impact	Very low	Nearly zero
Save location	Videos\Captures (automatic)	You choose at export
Best for	Capturing full stream	Audio track only

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